V A R N / BRAND SYSTEM

VARN

BUILT FOR WHAT'S NEXT.

BRAND GUIDELINES / VERSION 1.0

A practical visual system for a precise, modern technology brand.

CHARCOAL	NIGHT	STEEL	FOG	BONE	SAGE

BUILT FOR WHAT'S NEXT.

A Scandinavian-inspired identity system built around restraint, precision, and strong geometry.

01 / BRAND FOUNDATION

A quiet, confident identity

VARN should feel engineered rather than decorated: deliberate geometry, calm contrast, clear hierarchy, and visual details that earn their place. The system is designed to work equally well in software, technical documents, and physical product contexts.

POSITIONING

A modern technology brand associated with awareness, reliable systems, precision, and forward motion. Keep public descriptions grounded in the actual product and its verified capabilities.

PERSONALITY

Calm, capable, exact, and quietly ambitious. Never noisy, theatrical, over-militarized, or needlessly futuristic.

Three design principles

01

PRECISION

Use aligned grids, intentional spacing, and crisp edges. Every element should have a job.

02

RESTRAINT

Limit the palette, keep layouts spacious, and choose one focal point at a time.

03

READINESS

Make important information easy to spot. Prioritize clarity over visual spectacle.

Identity in practice

- Let the logo be a focal point, not a repeating decoration.
- Use charcoal and bone as the main visual pairing; steel blue and sage are supporting accents.
- Keep layouts calm even when the information is dense: clear labels, visible hierarchy, and consistent spacing.

VISUAL REFERENCE / APPROVED DIRECTION

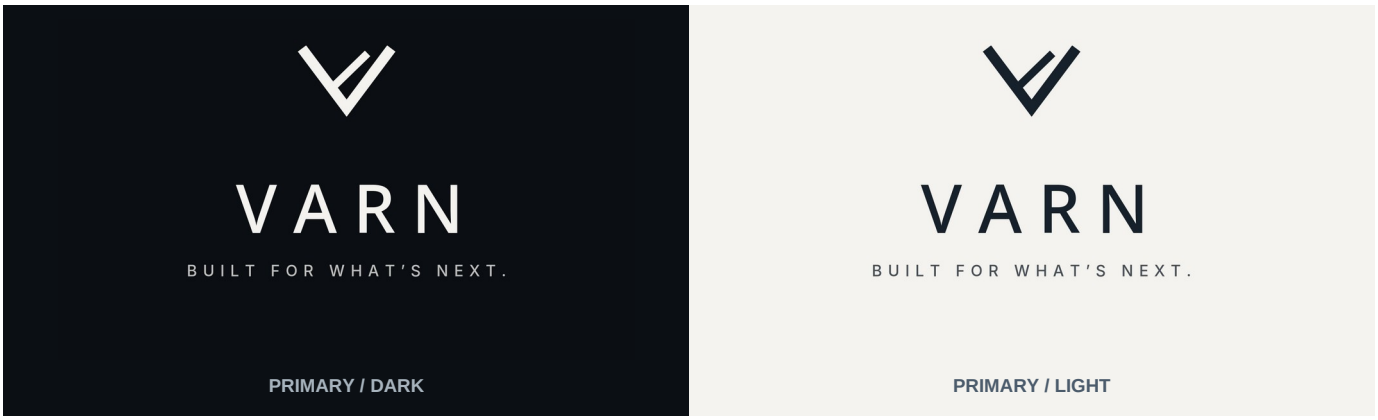


Reference moodboard: use as a direction-setting image, not as a literal specification for every future application.

02 / LOGO SYSTEM

One mark. Two primary environments.

The core identity combines the angular V mark with a widely spaced VARN wordmark. Use the stacked lockup for brand moments and the mark alone for compact applications such as app icons, avatars, and small product stamps.



Clear space and minimum size

CLEAR SPACE

Keep at least one mark-stem width of empty space around every side of the full lockup. When possible, leave more breathing room rather than less.

MINIMUM SIZE

Stacked lockup: 140 px wide on screen or 32 mm wide in print. Mark-only: 20 px high for UI icons; use a simplified high-contrast version at tiny sizes.

Do / do not

- Do use the supplied light logo on charcoal/night surfaces and the dark logo on bone/light surfaces.
- Do keep the mark and wordmark proportions fixed; center them as a single unit when stacked.
- Do not stretch, skew, outline, bevel, glow, or add shadows to the logo.
- Do not place the mark over high-detail photography without a calm contrast field behind it.
- Do not invent extra symbol parts or rotate the mark. Re-check tiny use for legibility.

Asset note: the included SVGs are clean starter vectors interpreting the approved concept. Compare the supplied artwork with the original reference before a final public release.

03 / COLOR SYSTEM

Muted, deliberate, high contrast

The palette starts with near-black charcoal and warm bone, then uses cool blue-gray and soft sage sparingly. Most screens should be built from charcoal/bone with steel or sage as a supporting accent.

VARN	VARN	VARN	VARN
DEEP CHARCOAL #0B0F14 Primary dark surfaces	**NIGHT** #111820 Secondary dark panels	**STEEL BLUE** #4B5B6B Links, secondary emphasis	**FOG** #A7B3BD Muted text on dark / dividers

VARN	VARN	VARN	VARN
BONE #F4F3EF Primary light surfaces	**SAGE** #7A8B7E Small accents, statuses, highlights	**INK** #17212B Primary text on light	**WHITE** #FFFFFF Use sparingly for contrast

Usage ratio

45% CHARCOAL	30% BONE	12% STEEL	8% FOG	5% SAGE

Ratio is a starting point, not a rule: prioritize legibility and context. Use bone text on charcoal; use ink text on bone. Avoid fog-colored body text on bone and avoid sage as a long-text color.

Contrast rule

For core reading text, favor high-contrast combinations: bone on charcoal/night and ink on bone/white. Do not rely on color alone to communicate status; pair accent colors with labels or icons.

04 / TYPOGRAPHY

Geometric display. Neutral reading.

The wordmark should remain custom artwork rather than being retyped. For all surrounding typography, use clean geometric sans-serif families with restrained tracking and clear hierarchy.

DISPLAY TYPE / SPACE GROTESK

BUILT FOR WHAT'S NEXT.

Headlines should be compact, sharp, and short.

DISPLAY / SPACE GROTESK

Use for headlines, short callouts, and large numeric values. Suggested weight: 500 or 600. Fallback stack: "Space Grotesk", "Inter", Arial, sans-serif.

BODY / INTER

Use for paragraphs, interface labels, navigation, and longer reading. Suggested weights: 400 and 500. Fallback stack: "Inter", Arial, sans-serif.

Type scale

ROLE	SIZE	WEIGHT	NOTES
Display / hero	48-72 px	Medium	Tight line height; short phrases only
H1	36-44 px	Medium	Clear, editorial hierarchy
H2	24-30 px	Medium	Section headings
H3	18-22 px	Medium	Card or module headings
Body	15-18 px	Regular	Comfortable reading line length
Caption / metadata	11-13 px	Medium	Use uppercase + tracking sparingly

Tracking and casing

- Use letter spacing on short uppercase labels, navigation, and the wordmark. Do not apply wide tracking to long body copy.
- Prefer sentence case for readable interface labels and explanatory text. Use uppercase mainly for small section labels and selected brand moments.
- Keep line lengths comfortable: around 55-80 characters for long-form text.

05 / VISUAL LANGUAGE

Angular geometry. Quiet atmosphere.

Shape language

GEOMETRY

Use angular cuts, diagonals, and simplified V-derived forms. Prefer solid silhouettes and clean negative space to complex illustrations. Keep corners mostly crisp; use small radii only for UI containers.

LINES & GRID

Thin dividers, consistent column alignment, and generous margins create structure. Use a 4 px base spacing scale and align components to multiples of 8 where possible.

Photography direction

- Choose real-feeling, low-saturation imagery: Nordic terrain, stone, brushed metal, glass, dark technical surfaces, fog, and open skies.
- Use strong composition and negative space. A single subject or material detail is better than a crowded scene.
- Favor charcoal shadows, cool steel tones, warm off-white highlights, and restrained natural greens.
- Avoid generic stock-photo smiles, neon sci-fi effects, excessive lens flares, over-sharpening, and over-saturated color.
- When showing products or systems, represent actual capabilities accurately; avoid imagery that implies features the product does not have.

UI surfaces and components

DARK SURFACE	LIGHT SURFACE	ACCENT
Main navigation, hero panels, product shell	Documents, technical detail, secondary pages	Small emphasis, active states, selected data

Spacing tokens

4 / 8 / 12 / 16 / 24 / 32 / 48 / 64 px. Use 24-32 px inner padding for standard cards; 40-64 px for large hero sections; 64-96 px between major website sections.

06 / APPLICATIONS & VOICE

Make every touchpoint feel related

WEB / SOFTWARE

- Dark charcoal shell with bone text and steel-blue interaction accents.
- Use restrained cards, thin dividers, compact uppercase metadata, and readable data hierarchy.
- Reserve sage for a small status or confirmation accent; always pair it with text.

PRESENTATIONS / DOCUMENTS

- 16:9 slides, generous margins, one main message per slide.
- Use a charcoal title slide, bone content slides, thin rules, and a consistent footer.
- Charts should use the palette sparingly and remain readable in grayscale.

Voice and messaging

SOUND LIKE	AVOID
Clear, calm, specific, direct, technically literate. State what a system does, for whom, and why it matters. Prefer facts, not superlatives.	“Revolutionary”, “unstoppable”, “world-changing”, vague futurism, fear-based copy, or technical claims that are not substantiated.

Copy examples

PREFER	AVOID
“Clearer awareness. More confident decisions.”	*“The most revolutionary system ever made.”*
“Designed for reliable operation in complex environments.”	*“Unstoppable technology that changes everything.”*

Tagline

BUILT FOR WHAT’S NEXT.

07 / IMPLEMENTATION

Quick handoff specifications

Logo files included

- `varn_logo_on_charcoal.svg` / `.png` — stacked primary lockup on dark background.
- `varn_logo_on_bone.svg` / `.png` — stacked primary lockup on light background.
- `varn_mark_light.svg` and `varn_mark_dark.svg` — mark-only transparent vectors.
- `varn_app_icon.svg` / `.png` — square app-icon starting point.
- `varn_design_tokens.css` — copy-ready web palette, type stacks, and spacing tokens.

Design tokens

TOKEN	VALUE	USE
--varn-charcoal	#0B0F14	Main dark background
--varn-bone	#F4F3EF	Main light background
--varn-steel-blue	#4B5B6B	Secondary accent
--varn-fog	#A7B3BD	Muted detail on dark
--varn-sage	#7A8B7E	Small accent/status
--varn-font-display	Space Grotesk / Inter	Display
--varn-font-body	Inter / Arial	Body
--varn-space-4	16 px	Base rhythm

Pre-launch checklist

- Confirm the vector mark matches the final approved logo exactly, then freeze a master SVG and outlined/vector-safe export.
- Check the selected wordmark and brand name with trademark counsel and verify relevant domains/social handles.
- Confirm licenses and availability for Space Grotesk and Inter; package approved font files only where licensing permits.
- Check logo contrast and minimum size on every actual background and device.
- Keep marketing descriptions accurate to real capabilities; avoid unsupported claims.

Status: design system v1.0. Visual recommendations are implementation guidance, not trademark clearance or legal advice.